

IT'S TELECOM ALL THE WAY!

Telecom networks traverse multiple cultures, diverse terrains, extreme climates, all shades of political ideology and labyrinthine governmental regulations. This makes telecom a minefield of opportunities for aspirants

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In the past three months, whenever I tried to figure out a ray of hope in the Indian electronics industry during this recession, it had to be the word 'telecom.' If there is one industry

which is showing tremendous growth, and will continue to expand, it is telecom. Aggressive marketing, falling tariff and cutthroat competition have led to its steady rise.

India is currently adding 8-10 million mobile subscribers every month.

Given the huge size of the nation and the fact that only 25 per cent of the population has communication network now, the future looks tremendously bright for the telecom industry. It is estimated that by mid 2012, around half of the country's population will own a mobile phone. This would translate into 612 million mobile subscribers, amounting to a tele-density of around 51 per cent. The telecom industry is expected to generate revenues worth \$43 billion by 2009-10.

According to The Associated Chambers of Commerce and Industry of India, the telecom industry attracted Rs 891-billion investments from major players in the first half of 2008 alone. Indian telecom is one of the fastest growing industries in the world and is projected to become the second largest telecom market globally by 2010. In April 2008, India overtook the US as the second largest wireless market, and as a pointer to the increasing global influence of Indian telecom companies, seven Indian firms have featured in the list of the world's 100 most influential telecom companies, compiled by *Global Telecoms Business*—an industry magazine.

"Considering that telecom is a booming sector even in times of the current economic recession, the demand for employable individuals is open. The types of firms that are engaged in recruiting are spread across, but not limited to, operators, integrators and vendors," informs Pius Maria Prasad, director-human resource, Huawei Technologies India.

The recruitment trend in the telecom industry further confirms this statement. Large telecom players like

